



Cherene de Bruyn

AFHEA

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KEY SKILLS AND ABILITIES

- Project Organization, & Time Management
- Communication & Interpersonal Skills
- Teamwork & Leadership
- Adaptability & Flexibility
- QGIS & Google Earth
- ArcGIS Online, Collector & Survey123
- MS Office Suite (Word, Excel, PowerPoint)
- Afrikaans, English (Excellent), French (Novice)

EDUCATION

2024-2028	Liverpool John Moores University, United Kingdom , Postgraduate Researcher in Molecular Biology, Biophysics and Biochemistry Project: The detection and investigation of mammalian remains using forensic ecology and remote sensing approaches. Supervisors: Dr T.K. Ralebitso-Senior, Dr K. Scott, Dr H. Panter, Dr F. Bezombes
2016/2017	University College London, United Kingdom , MA in Archaeology Thesis Title: Investigation and analysis of burial equipment of the royal tombs in Giza from the Fourth Dynasty, Egypt. Supervisors: Dr C. Näser and Dr A. Stevenson
2015	University of Pretoria, South Africa , BSc Honours in Physical Anthropology Research Project: A Bioarchaeological analysis of historic human skeletal remains recovered from Lancaster Mine, Witwatersrand. Supervisor: Dr A. Meyer
2013	University of Pretoria, South Africa , BA Honours in Archaeology Research Project: Investigations on an Iron Age settlement on a hill site in the Masebe Nature Reserve, Limpopo Province. Supervisor: Dr C. Ashley
2010-2012	University of Pretoria, South Africa , BA Archaeology, Anthropology, and Ancient Culture Studies

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2024-Present	Teaching Support Officer, Liverpool John Moores University, Liverpool, UK
2022-2023	Archaeologist, Museum of London Archaeology, Northampton, UK
2020-2022	Archaeologist, PGS Heritage, Pretoria, RSA
2018	Heritage Manager, Archaeologist and Heritage Consultant, NGT Holdings, Johannesburg, RSA
2018	Lascaux Exhibition Tour Guide, Sci-Bono Discovery Centre, Newtown, RSA
2018	Field and Lab Assistant, Umbelli Beli Middle Stone Age Excavations, KwaZulu-Natal Province, RSA
2017	Causal worker, Tower Bridge Exhibition, City of London, UK
2017-2019	PAST-ASAPA Southern African Archaeology Student Council Event's Organizer
2016	Field and Lab Assistant, Umbelli Beli Middle Stone Age Excavations, KwaZulu-Natal Province, RSA
2016	Field and Lab Assistant, Leakey Foundation and Wenner-Gren Foundation-funded Grassridge Archaeological and Palaeoenvironmental Project, Eastern Cape Province, RSA
2016	Archaeological Contractor, Bio-Archaeological Analysis and Archaeological Geophysics Unit, University of Pretoria, RSA
2015	Teaching Assistant, Human Osteology (ANA 122), Department of Anatomy, University of Pretoria, RSA

2015	Field and Lab Assistant, Leakey Foundation and Wenner-Gren Foundation-funded Grassridge Archaeological and Palaeoenvironmental Project, Eastern Cape Province, RSA
2014	DST-NRF Archaeological Intern, Forensic Anthropological Research Center, Department of Anatomy, University of Pretoria, RSA
2013	Heritage Tourism Management (EFK 120) Student Tutor, Department of Anthropology and Archaeology, University of Pretoria, RSA
2012	Student Field Assistant, Department of Anthropology and Archaeology, University of Pretoria, Archaeology Field School in Phokeng, Boekenhoutfontein Farm, North West Province, RSA
2011	Student Field Assistant, Department of Anthropology and Archaeology, University of Pretoria, Archaeology Field School in Lephelale, Limpopo Province, RSA
2010	Student Field Assistant, Department of Anthropology and Archaeology, University of Pretoria Archaeology Field School in Sudwala Caves, Lydenburg, Mpumalanga Province, RSA

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

2026	Associate Fellow of the Higher Education Academy (AFHEA): Advance HE
2026-2031	UK Civil Aviation Authority: Drone Pilot A2 Category
2024-2027	British Association for Forensic Anthropology (BAFA): Student Member
2022-2027	Academically Qualified Person AQP: Construction Skills Certification Scheme (CSCS)
2018-2022	Accredited Professional Heritage Practitioner: International Association for Impact Assessment, South Africa
Since 2016	Accredited Professional Archaeologist: Association of Southern African Professional Archaeologists. Accreditation in Cultural Resources Management: - Principal Investigator: Grave relocation - Field Director: Colonial Period archaeology, Iron Age archaeology - Field Supervisor: Rock art, Stone Age archaeology - Laboratory Specialist: Human Skeletal Remains
Since 2011	Golden Key International Honour Society, Member

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

2026	Reviewer, <i>Science and Justice</i> , Elsevier
2025-Present	Journal Co-Founder and Managing Editor, <i>LJMU ASPIRE Journal</i>
2024-Present	Sub-Editor, Research Hive – Science communication Blog Online
2015-2018	Reviewer, <i>International Journal of Student Research in Archaeology</i>

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEER

2025-2026	School of Pharmacy and Biomolecular Science PGR Research Conference Organising Committee
2025-Present	School of Pharmacy and Biomolecular Science PGR Representative
2025-Present	Merseyside Archaeology Society Council. Liverpool
2016- 2017	Student Volunteer: UCL Institute of Archaeology, University Archaeology Day, London and World Archaeology Festival, London Student Volunteer, Royal Anthropology Institute Film Festival 2016, Bristol Student Volunteer, Current Archaeology LIVE 2017 Conference, Senate House, London Student Volunteer, Petrie Museum of Egyptian Archaeology, University College London

AWARDS

2026	FameLab Science Communication Competition Northwest Region Winner, 24 March 2026
2017	Chevening Bronze Award, 30 hours of Volunteering in 2016/2017, Chevening Secretariat and Foreign and Commonwealth Office
2012	Student Award for the Best Student in Archaeology, Third Year, Department of Anthropology and Archaeology, University of Pretoria
2010	Golden Rhino Award for the Best Academic Performance in Archaeology First year, Department of Anthropology and Archaeology, University of Pretoria

GRANTS

2026	Faculty of Health, Innovation, Technology and Science Research Innovation Fund - Awarded: £8050,00 Project: Advancing forensic burial detection: Integrating microbial genomics, remote sensing, and machine learning across climates Recipients: C. de Bruyn, Dr T.K. Ralebitso-Senior, Dr K. Scott, Dr H. Panter, Dr F. Bezombes, Dr P. Shum and Professor S. Wich
2025	Turing Scheme Research Placement - Awarded: £838.00 Project: Research visit to the University of Copenhagen, Denmark, 4 May -30 May 2025 Recipients: C. de Bruyn and Dr T.K. Ralebitso-Senior (Lead)
2025	FORRI Research Support 2025 (19 December 2025) - Awarded: £5000.00 Project: Support towards research visit to the University of Cape Town, South Africa and sequencing of soil samples Recipients: C. de Bruyn (PGR; Lead), Dr K. Scott, Dr H. Panter, Dr F. Bezombes and Dr T.K. Ralebitso-Senior
2025	FORRI Research Scholarship 2025 (2 July 2026) - Awarded: £1000.00 Project: Funding to support the Winter 2025 Forensic Taphonomy experiment the University of Cape Town (UCT), South Africa Recipients: C. de Bruyn (PGR; Lead), Dr K. Scott, Dr H. Panter, Dr F. Bezombes and Dr T.K. Ralebitso-Senior
2025	FORRI Research Support 2025 - Awarded: £5000.00 Project: FORRI research support towards the University of Cape Town, South Africa and the University of Copenhagen, Denmark Collaboration Recipients: C. de Bruyn (PGR; Lead), Dr K. Scott, Dr H. Panter, Dr F. Bezombes and Dr T.K. Ralebitso-Senior
2024	AMI Student Travel Bursary - Awarded: £200.00 Project: Conference funding to attend the AMI MMEG 2024 on 16-18 December 2024 Recipients: C. de Bruyn
2024	LJMU Doctoral Academy PGR Conference Travel Fund - Awarded: £200.00 Project: Conference funding to attend the AMI MMEG 2024 on 16-18 December 2024 Recipients: C. de Bruyn
2024	British Association for Biological Anthropology and Osteoarchaeology (BABAO) Microgrant - Awarded: £200.00 Project: Conference funding to attend the British Association for Forensic Anthropology Winter conference, 30 November - 1 December 2024, Oxford, UK Recipients: C. de Bruyn
2024	FORRI Research Support: June 2024 - Awarded: £5567.00 Project: Forensic research visit and collaboration with the University of Cape Town (UCT), South Africa Recipients: Dr T.K. Ralebitso-Senior (Lead) and C. de Bruyn
2024	FORRI Research Support: June 2024 - Awarded: £2353.00

Project: Forensic Research Visit to University of Central Lancashire (UCLan)
 Recipients: C. de Bruyn (PGR; Lead), Dr K. Scott, Dr H. Panter, Dr F. Bezombes and Dr T.K. Ralebitso-Senior

- 2016** Chevening Scholarship for Master's study in the UK, British High Commission, Chevening Secretariat, and FCO
- 2013** Conference Funding, Wenner-Gren Foundation, ASAPA Conference in Botswana
- 2013** Kent Bequest - Awarded: R4000.00. South African Archaeological Society, Project: BA Honours project

COURSES & WORKSHOPS

- 2026** Supporting Learning Certificate, SEDA
- 2026** FameLab Science Communication Masterclass and Media Training, Cheltenham, 1-2 May 2026
- 2026** Courtroom Communication, The Leverhulme Research Centre for Forensic Science, University of Dundee and The Alan Alda Center for Communicating Science at Stony Brook University, 17 March 2026-23 April 2026
- 2025** Trauma and Taphonomy Workshop, British Association for Forensic Anthropology Conference, Liverpool, 29-30 November 2025
- 2025** LEAP Leadership Program 2025, oikos International and Principles of Responsible Management Education, April-September 2025
- 2025** Certified Peer Reviewer Course, Elsevier Researcher Academy
- 2025** Leading with Character, The Oxford Character Project, University of Oxford
- 2024** 3IS Training, LJMU, Liverpool
- 2024** NEOF Metabarcoding and environmental DNA wetlab and bioinformatics, University of Sheffield, 22-26 July 2024
- 2024** Practical in Laboratory Skills and Biotechnology Bootcamp, BioGrad Liverpool, 29 June-10 May 2024
- 2024** Human vs Non-Human - CPD workshop (Online) British Association for Forensic Anthropology, 13th July 2024
- 2023** Forensic Anthropology: An introduction to human osteology, Anglian Ruskin University, 11-12 November 2023
- 2023** Everyday ethics: An introduction to professional ethics and developing your ethical knowledge, Chartered Institute for Archaeologists
- 2022** Training Services Programme in Manual Handling, City & Guilds Accredited Programme
- 2021** Heritage Resources Management, University of Cape Town, RSA
- 2019** Level 5 Certificate in Teaching English as a Foreign Language (168 hours), The TEFL Academy
- 2017** Egyptian Archaeology Skills School, Egypt Exploration Society, London, UK

PUBLICATIONS

- de Bruyn, C., Scott, K., Panter, H., Bezombes, F. and Ralebitso-Senior, T.K., 2025. Advancing time-since-interval estimation for clandestine graves: From traditional approaches to forensic ecogenomics using massively parallel sequencing. *Frontiers in Microbiology*, 16, p.1684366 <https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/microbiology/articles/10.3389/fmicb.2025.1684366/full>
- de Bruyn, C., Ralebitso-Senior, K., Scott, K., Panter, H. and Bezombes, F., 2025. Search, Detect, Recover: A systematic review of UAV-based remote sensing approaches for the location of human remains and clandestine graves. *Drones*, 9(10), p.674 <https://www.mdpi.com/2504-446X/9/10/674>
- Harcombe, M. & de Bruyn, C. & Shadrach, K. & Tembe, E. & Bansal, S. & Fraser, L. & Forssman, T. & Lotter, M. 2020. The Southern African Archaeology Student Council. Reflecting on the road thus far and reimagining the future. *The Digging Stick Volume*, 37 (2): 9-13

- de Bruyn, C. & Meyer, A. 2018. Bioarchaeological analysis of the historic human skeletal remains recovered from Lancaster Mine, Witwatersrand, South Africa. *The South African Archaeological Bulletin*, 73(207): 4-12
- Meyer, A. & de Bruyn, C. 2018. Bioarchaeological analysis of historic human skeletal remains recovered from the Lancaster Gold Mine premises, Witwatersrand. A Selection of Abstracts Presented at the 44th Annual Conference of the Anatomical Society of Southern Africa (ASSA), May 8–11, 2016, Bloem Spa Hotel and Conference Centre, Bloemfontein, Free State, South Africa, *Clinical Anatomy*, 31(8): E18
- de Bruyn, C. & Jordaan, J. 2017. Regional feature: Perspectives from Southern African archaeology professionals. *International Journal of Student Research in Archaeology*, 2(3): 2-18
- de Bruyn, C. 2014. An archaeological investigation in the Masebe Nature Reserve, Limpopo Province, *The Digging Stick*, 31(1):9-11

PRESENTATIONS & TALKS

- Making your research matter: policy and practice engagement for doctoral researchers. Emily Walker-Williams, Liz Edwards, Cherene de Bruyn, & Nosa Aikodon. [LJMU Students at Heart Conference 16-17 June 2026](#)
- Eye in the Sky: Drones on the trail of finding hidden graves. Famelab Science Communication Competition Cheltenham Science Festival, Cheltenham, UK. 5 June 2026
- Computer vision for locating clandestine burial sites using UAV-image data. School of Pharmacy and Biomolecular Science Postgraduate Research Day. Liverpool, UK. 28 May 2026
- An Eye for Detail: Finessing my FameLab UK talk on finding forensic graves. LJMU Doctoral Academy PGR Festival. Liverpool, UK. 19 May 2026
- Eye in the Sky: Drones on the trail of the missing. Famelab Science Communication Competition NW-Region. Liverpool, UK. 24 March 2026. (NW-Winner)
- Soil-ving the Case: Using microbes to find hidden graves. 3MT Faculty of Health, Innovation, Technology and Science, LJMU. Liverpool, UK. 2026 (HITS Faculty Finalist & LJMU People Choice Award)
- Clandestine grave detection and time since intervals – Where do we stand? British Association for Human Identification (BAHID) Webinar. 14 January 2026
- Justice from the ground up: Exploring multidisciplinary approaches for grave detection. LJMU Research Knowledge Exchange Conference. Forensic Research Institute Session. Liverpool, UK. 15 December 2025
- More or less? A mini study comparing soil and forensic DNA extraction kits using variable soil inputs. School of Pharmacy and Biomolecular Science Research Day. Liverpool, UK. 30 June 2025. (Best Presentation Winner)
- Student research excellence: something to ASPIRE to. School of Pharmacy and Biomolecular Science PGR Research Day. 30 June 2025. Bones, Drones & Microbes. Research Roasters Outreach Day. Liverpool, UK. 5 November 2025
- Finding the Missing. Postgraduate Research Panel. British Science Festival Liverpool X Research Roasters. Liverpool, UK. 10 September 2025
- Graveyard Shift: From Grave Relocation to Grave Detection. Merseyside Archaeology Society Evening Lecture: New research by Liverpool students. Liverpool, UK. 20 February 2025
- The Hidden Forensics: Soil Microbiomes and Ecogenomic Insights from Graves by Dr Komang Ralebitso-Senior and Cherene de Bruyn. Hosted via MS Teams (online) by the University of Cape Town, South Africa. 26 August 2024
- The Hidden Forensics: Soil Microbiomes and Ecogenomic Insights from Graves by Dr Komang Ralebitso-Senior and Cherene de Bruyn. University of Cape Town, South Africa. 27 June 2024
- Grave Matters: The science behind forensic investigations. BioGrad. Liverpool, UK. 10 May 2024

A bio-archaeological analysis of historic human skeletal remains recovered from Lancaster Mine, Witwatersrand. Presented at the Student Development Workshop 2015, Southern African Archaeology Student Council. Magaliesberg, 30 November-5 December 2015

Living on a Foothill: An archaeological investigation of the Iron Age settlement found in the Masebe Nature Reserve located in the Waterberg, Limpopo Province. Presented at the Association of Southern African Professional Archaeologists Student Development workshop. Parys, South Africa, 15-19 November 2013

POSTERS

de Bruyn, C., Scott, K., Panter, H., Bezombes, F. and Ralebitso-Senior, K., 2026. GRAVES: A framework for forensic research. Migrant Disaster Victim Identification Action Event, International Association of Forensic Sciences Conference. Sofia, Bulgaria. 25-30 May 2026

de Bruyn, C., Scott, K., Panter, H., Bezombes, F. and Ralebitso-Senior, K., 2024. From decay to discovery: The necrobiome's role in clandestine grave detection. AMI MMEG: Molecular Microbial Ecology Group 2024, Southampton, UK. 16 December 2024

de Bruyn, C., Scott, K., Panter, H., Bezombes, F. and Ralebitso-Senior, K., 2024. Unseen connections: Why multidisciplinary approaches matter in the identification and detection of human remains. British Association for Forensic Anthropology (BAFA) Winter conference and AGM 2024. Conference Theme: "Bridging the gap between academia and practice, Oxford, UK. 30 November 2024

Meyer, A. & de Bruyn, C. 2014. Bioarchaeological analysis of historic human skeletal remains recovered from the Lancaster Gold Mine premises, Witwatersrand. 44th Annual Conference of the Anatomical Society of Southern Africa, Bloemfontein, Free State Province, South Africa, May 8-11, 2016

de Bruyn, C., Nienaber, W.C., & Meyer, A. 2014. Reconstructing the past: An analysis of inadvertently discovered skeletal remains and archaeological material from the Soutpansberg region. DST-NRF 2014-2015 Intern's Research Presentation Day, Birchwood Hotel & OR Tambo Conference Centre, 20 February 2015

de Bruyn, C. 2013. Living on a foothill: Archaeological investigations on a hill settlement in the Masebe Nature Reserve, preliminary results. Association of Southern African Professional Archaeologists Biennial Conference, University of Botswana, Gaborone, Botswana, 3-7 July 2013

ONLINE/BLOG ARTICLES

De Bruyn, C. June 2026. [Parameters of Animal Self-Medication Behavior](#), The Observatory Human Bridges

de Bruyn, C. April 2026. [Why Teaching Deserves Thought: The Case for Associate Fellow of the Higher Education Academy \(AFHEA\)](#). Research Hive

de Bruyn, C. Decemeber 2025. [Parameters of Animal Mortuary Behavior](#). The Observatory Human Bridges

de Bruyn, C. August 2025. [The PhD Confirmation process is not a hurdle – It's a crucible](#). Research Hive.

de Bruyn, C. September 2024. [Starting Strong: Productivity Tips for the First 6 Months of Your PhD](#). Research Hive

TECHNICAL AND HERITAGE IMPACT REPORTS

Available on request